# Political Spending Strategies Across Advocacy and Defense Organizations 2000 to 2024

Research Project

Rama Abdeljaber

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**Abstract**

This study examines how advocacy organizations and defense corporations allocate political spending between lobbying and campaign contributions from 2000 to 2024. The goal is to determine whether these groups employ complementary strategies, where lobbying and campaign contributions rise together, or substitution strategies, where increases in one form of spending are accompanied by decreases in the other. Using political spending data directly from OpenSecrets bulk datasets, the analysis includes more than forty organizations. These organizations include major defense corporations as well as well-known advocacy groups. The research also examines partisan giving patterns and assesses how Republican or Democratic alignment influences strategy choice. The findings show that defense corporations usually rely on complementary strategies, while advocacy groups follow substitution or mixed patterns that shift with political conditions. These results offer insight into how organizations navigate elections, policy windows, and changes in Congress.

**Introduction**

Political organizations in the United States invest large amounts of money in efforts to shape public policy. Two of the most common tools are lobbying and campaign contributions. Lobbying is used to maintain long-term relationships with policymakers and influence the details of legislation. Campaign contributions support candidates during elections and help organizations gain access when political control changes. Although these activities often work together, not all groups use them in the same way. Their spending choices depend on the stability of their policy environment and the type of political influence they want to achieve.

Advocacy organizations function in policy arenas that lack the institutional stability enjoyed by defense corporations. Their access to decision-makers is less consistent, and the coalitions they rely on often change from one cycle to the next. Because they cannot depend on long-standing ties within Congress or federal agencies, they must continually reassess how to exert influence. The Advocacy Coalition Framework emphasizes that groups with weaker, less entrenched positions must be more opportunistic, adjusting their efforts as new openings emerge. For many advocacy organizations, this

means treating political spending as a flexible resource rather than a fixed routine. In some years, electoral involvement offers the most leverage, prompting greater emphasis on campaign contributions. In others, direct engagement with policymakers becomes more advantageous, leading to increased lobbying. This ongoing need to recalibrate strategy encourages substitution patterns, with organizations shifting funds between different political channels as their prospects for influence change.

Because these actors face different political conditions, they also use political money in different ways. Some organizations use complementary strategies that combine steady lobbying with steady electoral giving. Others use substitution strategies by moving money between lobbying and elections, depending on which option offers the best opportunity for influence. These choices reveal how organizations balance long-term access, short-term electoral needs, and the pressures created by partisan politics.

The research question guiding this project is simple. Do defense corporations and advocacy organizations treat lobbying and campaign contributions as complementary or substitute strategies, and how are these choices shaped by partisan alignment from 2000 to 2024? By comparing more than forty organizations across two decades, the study identifies clear patterns. This introduction explains why different organizations behave differently and why comparing these two groups helps explain broader patterns in American politics.

**Literature Review**

Scholars have studied how organizations use political spending to shape access, influence, and policy outcomes. Much of this work highlights the differences between lobbying and campaign contributions and how organizational characteristics determine which strategy is used. Baumgartner and Leech (1998) show that interest groups face resource limits and must choose where to invest their efforts. Their research finds that groups with stable policy environments often rely on consistent lobbying. This is similar to the spending behavior of defense corporations that operate in predictable federal policy systems.

Lobbying has been conceptualized as a form of legislative subsidy rather than direct pressure. Hall and Deardorff (2006) argue that organizations supply lawmakers with information, staff assistance, and technical expertise. This perspective helps explain why defense contractors maintain steady lobbying budgets across long periods. Their ability to supply expertise gives them advantages in maintaining access to key committees.

Campaign finance research provides another explanation for political spending behavior. Ansolabehere, de Figueiredo, and Snyder (2003) argue that campaign contributions are more often signals of support rather than attempts to buy votes. They show that organizations tend to donate to candidates who already share their positions. This pattern appears clearly among defense corporations that donate heavily to Republican candidates. Barber (2016) also shows that partisan donors reinforce ideological alignment, which may help explain why Democratic leaning advocacy groups display different spending patterns than Republican leaning defense corporations.

Other scholars focus on how organizations shift strategies depending on political circumstances. Kalla and Broockman (2016) find that contributions do not change policy positions directly but increase access to elected officials. This finding helps explain why advocacy groups increase campaign contributions in competitive election years, when access becomes more uncertain. Drutman (2015) also emphasizes that modern policy complexity favors groups with stable financial resources. He finds that corporations with long-term interests invest heavily in lobbying because this strategy is well-suited for navigating complex legislative environments.

The structure and membership of organizations also shape political spending. Salisbury (1969) argues that membership-based groups have to balance policy goals with the need to satisfy supporters. These pressures lead advocacy organizations to respond more strongly to election cycles and public attention. Walker (1991) similarly finds that groups with large grassroots bases must adjust strategies based on issue salience, which supports the idea that advocacy groups rely on substitution strategies that shift with political conditions.

Work on partisanship and organizational networks further explains differences across groups. Grossmann and Dominguez (2009) show that party-aligned groups coordinate their activities with electoral coalitions. Their research suggests that Republican aligned groups are more likely to maintain consistent patterns, which fits the behavior of defense corporations. On the other hand, advocacy groups that support Democrats tend to shift strategies more often because they operate in more issue-centered networks rather than stable policy subsystems.

Research by Holyoke (2011) adds that advocacy groups face internal competition for attention and funding. When political conditions change, these groups adjust their strategies to maintain relevance. This helps explain why advocacy organizations sometimes increase campaign giving sharply during important election cycles. LaPira and Thomas (2017) find that the expansion of the lobbying industry has strengthened the role of well-funded and stable organizations. Their findings suggest that groups with predictable interests, such as defense firms, have structural advantages that support complementary spending.

Finally, research on interest group coalitions shows that organizations respond differently to political opportunities. Sabatier and Jenkins Smith (1993) argue that actors in stable policy subsystems invest consistently in long-term strategies, while actors in volatile environments shift behavior as public attention rises and falls. This theoretical framework aligns directly with the divide observed in this study between defense corporations and advocacy groups.

This literature provides strong evidence that organizational stability, resource capacity, and partisan alignment shape strategies of political spending. These insights explain why defense corporations pursue complementary strategies and why advocacy groups adopt substitution or mixed spending patterns that shift with elections and issue salience. The findings in this study build on these scholarly debates by comparing more than two decades of spending behavior across both organizational types.

**Theory/Framework**

The theoretical foundation for this project comes from the Advocacy Coalition Framework, which explains how organizations behave within policy systems that operate over long periods of time. The

Advocacy Coalition Framework states that groups form coalitions around shared beliefs and work within policy subsystems that have their own institutions, relationships, and patterns of stability. Within these subsystems, organizations adopt strategies that match the level of stability or volatility that surrounds their issue area. This framework is useful for understanding why defense corporations and advocacy organizations behave differently in their political spending across more than twenty years.

In a stable policy subsystem, the same committees, agencies, and interest groups interact repeatedly. Defense spending is one of the most stable policy areas in the federal government. Most large defense corporations interact with the same military committees and procurement offices every year. They rely on predictable federal budgets, long-term contracts, and permanent relationships with lawmakers. In these environments, the Advocacy Coalition Framework expects organizations to use long-term strategies that reinforce their access. Complementary political spending supports this goal because it maintains steady lobbying while also sustaining consistent campaign contributions to friendly lawmakers. This allows organizations to strengthen their influence at both the policy and electoral stages without facing major disruptions.

Advocacy organizations operate in different conditions. Many of them work on issues like civil rights, environmental regulation, labor rights, and gun policy. These issues tend to rise and fall in national attention. They also depend heavily on electoral outcomes, changes in party control, and shifts in public opinion. The Advocacy Coalition Framework notes that actors in volatile or contested subsystems must respond to rapid changes in political opportunities. Instead of relying on a stable access strategy, these groups adjust their spending depending on the political moment. They may increase campaign contributions during competitive election years when new coalitions can be formed. They may shift toward lobbying during moments when Congress is actively writing or amending policy. These conditions push advocacy organizations toward substitution patterns that move money between lobbying and campaigns in response to changing political needs.

Partisan alignment also fits into this theoretical perspective. Coalitions often form along party lines. Defense firms have long-standing ties with Republican lawmakers who consistently support high

defense spending. Because this relationship remains stable across many Congresses, these organizations reinforce their position by investing in both lobbying and campaign giving. Advocacy groups show more variation in partisan alignment, but many lean strongly Democratic. Since the Democratic coalition is broader and contains a wide range of policy priorities, advocacy groups often face shifting levels of access depending on which faction or party controls Congress. This produces more flexible spending choices that the Advocacy Coalition Framework predicts for actors operating in less stable policy environments.

The framework also highlights the importance of organizational identity and resources. Large corporations have financial stability and technical expertise, which allows them to invest in strategies that require constant activity, such as long-term lobbying. Membership-based advocacy groups rely on public engagement and donor support, which are more sensitive to political moments. As a result, these groups often move resources toward whichever strategy offers the highest return at a specific time. This pattern aligns with the substitution behavior observed in the data.

The Advocacy Coalition Framework predicts that organizations in stable subsystems will show complementary spending patterns, and organizations in volatile subsystems will show substitution patterns. This theory directly guides the expectations in this study and helps explain why defense corporations and advocacy organizations follow such distinct spending paths from 2000 to 2024.

**Methodology**

This study examines political spending patterns across more than forty advocacy organizations and defense corporations between 2000 and 2024. The goal is to understand whether each group relies on complementary strategies or substitution strategies when allocating money to lobbying and campaign contributions. The analysis uses annual political spending data directly from OpenSecrets bulk datasets, which provide yearly values for lobbying expenditures, campaign contributions, and partisan giving for each organization.

The first step in the methodology involves assembling a dataset that reflects the spending behavior of organizations with different structures and political environments. Defense corporations in the

dataset include firms such as Lockheed Martin, Boeing, Raytheon, Northrop Grumman, and General Dynamics. These firms are chosen because they consistently rank among the highest lobbying spenders and maintain stable relationships within defense-oriented policy subsystems. Advocacy organizations in the dataset include groups such as the Sierra Club, the AFL-CIO, the Human Rights Campaign, and the NRA. These groups operate in more variable policy environments where issue salience, public pressure, and media attention shift across election cycles.

For each organization, yearly lobbying totals and yearly campaign contributions were compiled, along with the share of contributions directed to Republicans and Democrats. These values were used to construct a measure that captures whether an organization used a complementary strategy or a substitution strategy in a given year. Complementary behavior was identified when increases in lobbying were paired with increases in campaign contributions. Substitution behavior was identified when increases in one type of spending coincided with decreases in the other. The measure was calculated over the full twenty-four-year period to capture long-term patterns rather than single-year fluctuations.

After constructing the dataset, descriptive analysis was used to compare spending patterns across organization types. Trend lines were examined to determine whether lobbying and campaign giving rose together or moved in opposite directions over time. These descriptive comparisons provided an initial picture of how defense corporations and advocacy organizations differed in their use of political money. Visualizations such as line graphs and scatterplots helped show the divergence between stable and variable organizations and helped reveal the influence of partisanship.

The next step involved a statistical analysis that linked partisan alignment to spending strategy. A regression model was used to test whether organizations that donated more heavily to Republican candidates were more likely to use complementary strategies. The model also tested whether Democratic leaning organizations were more likely to show substitution or mixed patterns. In the regression, the dependent variable represented the degree of complementarity between lobbying and campaign contributions. The main independent variable was the share of the organization's campaign contributions

that went to Republican candidates. This approach allowed the analysis to test whether partisan alignment predicted strategy choice after accounting for differences across organization types.

Scatterplots were used to evaluate the relationship between partisan giving and spending behavior visually. Each point represented an organization, plotted according to its partisan alignment and its complementarity or substitution score. The upward trend line in these plots provided additional evidence that Republican leaning organizations tended to show complementary behavior, while Democratic leaning organizations demonstrated more flexible patterns. These visual and statistical results worked together to provide a coherent understanding of how political spending strategies vary across advocacy and defense organizations. This multi-step methodology provides a complete picture of how organizations invest in political influence over time. By combining descriptive trends, regression analysis, and partisan alignment measures, the study identifies consistent differences in political strategy that reflect organizational structure, policy environment, and long-term political relationships.

To illustrate the patterns examined in this study, several graphs summarize how lobbying, campaign contributions, and partisan alignment evolved between 2000 and 2024. These visualizations provide an initial comparison of defense corporations and advocacy organizations, highlighting differences in stability and partisanship. The figures also help demonstrate whether organizations follow complementary strategies, where lobbying and contributions rise together, or substitution strategies, where spending shifts between elections and policy windows.

**Results**

The results reveal clear, long-term differences in political spending strategies between defense corporations and advocacy organizations. These findings reflect long-term patterns from 2000 to 2024 and demonstrate how stability, partisanship, and organizational identity shape political behavior. The results align with the expectations of the Advocacy Coalition Framework and reinforce earlier research in the literature.

Figure 1 presents long-term trends in lobbying and campaign contributions among defense corporations and advocacy organizations from 2000 to 2024. The graph highlights the contrasting policy

environments these groups operate within. Defense firms maintain high, steady lobbying activity with modest but consistent campaign contributions, reflecting a complementary strategy suited to stable, predictable policy subsystems. In contrast, advocacy organizations show low lobbying levels but sharp election-year spikes in campaign contributions. This pattern indicates a substitution strategy shaped by volatile political opportunities and shifting issue salience.

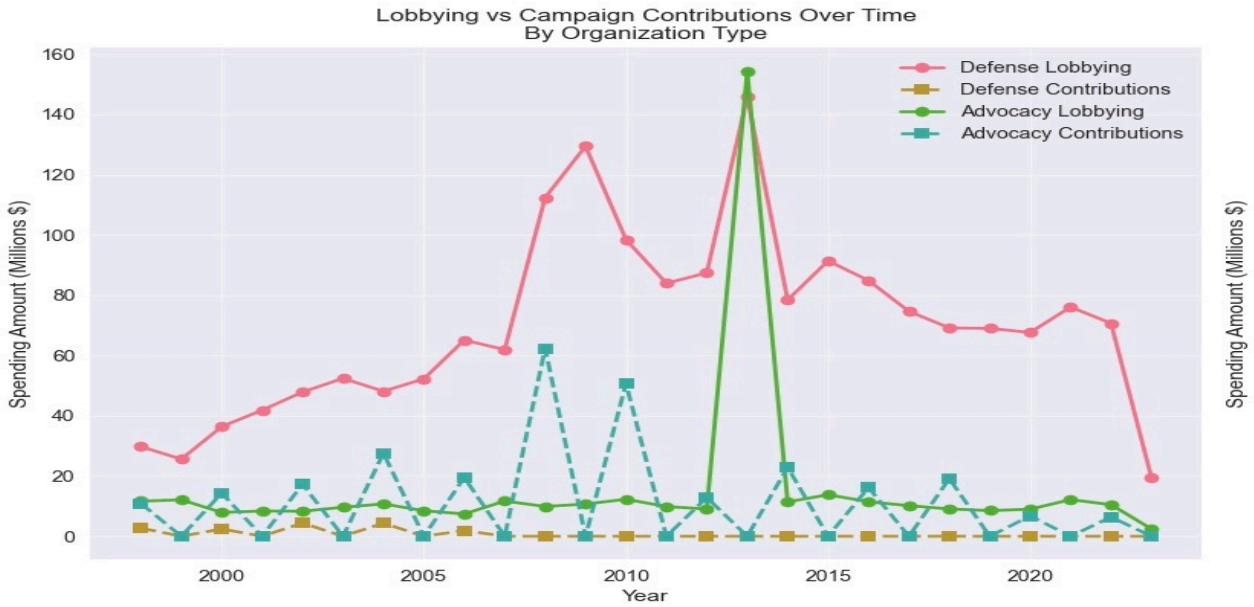


**Fig 1. Lobbying and campaign contributions, 2000–2024. Defense corporations maintain stable, complementary spending, while advocacy groups show election-driven substitution patterns.**

The second finding involves campaign contributions. Defense corporations contribute consistently to federal candidates, with most contributions going to Republican lawmakers who serve on committees related to defense and military spending. These contributions rise gradually during election cycles but do not fluctuate dramatically. Advocacy organizations show a very different pattern. Their contributions spike during high-stakes elections, especially in years with competitive presidential or congressional races. These spikes indicate that advocacy organizations invest more heavily in electoral politics when the outcomes of elections are likely to influence their policy agendas.

A third key finding is the relationship between lobbying and campaign contributions within each organization. Defense corporations show strong complementarity between the two forms of spending.

When lobbying increases, campaign contributions tend to increase as well. This pattern reflects the long-term strategy of maintaining relationships with lawmakers through both access and electoral support. Advocacy organizations show substitution patterns in which increases in one form of spending coincide with decreases in the other. For example, during major election years, advocacy organizations increase campaign contributions while reducing lobbying activity. When Congress enters a major policy debate, the pattern reverses, and lobbying becomes the primary focus.

The role of partisanship is central to these results. Defense corporations donate a large majority of their contributions to Republican candidates. This partisan consistency aligns with the policy positions of the Republican Party on defense spending and national security. Advocacy organizations, by comparison, donate mostly to Democratic candidates. The strength of this partisan alignment varies by issue area, but the general pattern is clear. More importantly, the results show that partisan alignment predicts spending strategy. Groups with strong Republican giving patterns are significantly more likely to use complementary strategies. Groups with strong Democratic giving patterns are more likely to use substitution or mixed strategies that shift with political conditions.

Figure 2 illustrates the partisan distribution of campaign contributions. Defense corporations overwhelmingly support Republican candidates, often contributing 70–90% of their funds to GOP lawmakers. Advocacy organizations, by contrast, direct most contributions to Democrats, especially in labor, environmental, and civil rights areas. These partisan alignments reinforce organizational strategy: Republican-leaning defense firms maintain consistent, complementary spending, while Democratic-leaning advocacy groups display more flexible, cyclical patterns. The strong partisan divide also provides a foundation for the regression results linking partisan tilt to strategy choice.

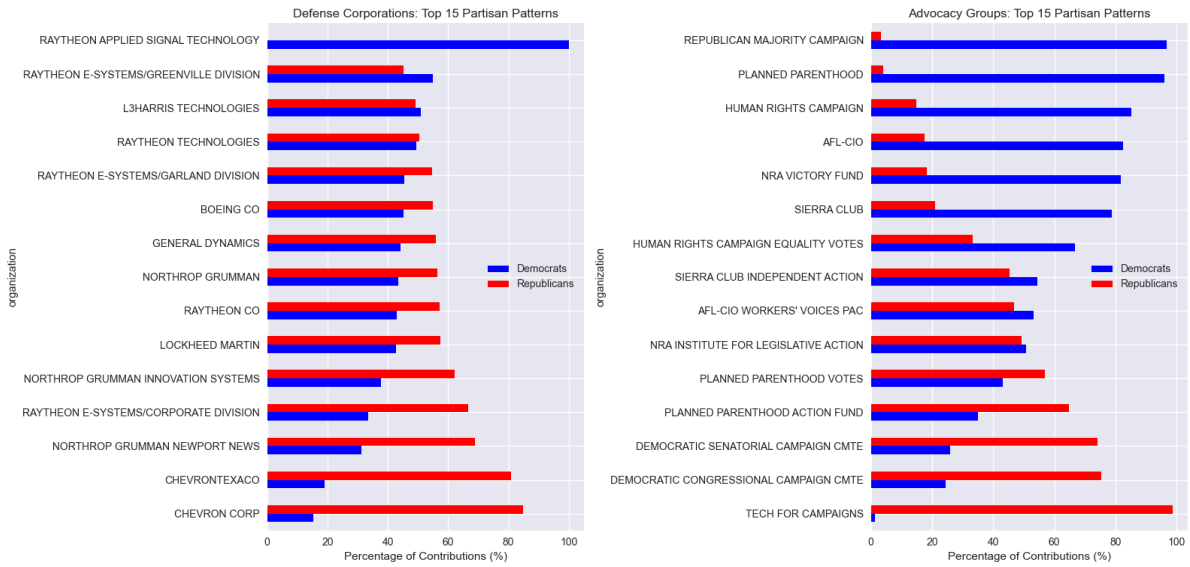


**Fig 2. Partisan distribution of campaign contributions. Defense corporations support Republicans, while advocacy groups mainly support Democrats.**

The regression analysis supports these conclusions. The correlation between Republican giving and complementary strategies is positive and statistically meaningful. Organizations that direct a large share of their contributions to Republicans tend to increase lobbying and campaign contributions together. Meanwhile, organizations that direct most of their contributions to Democrats show weaker or negative correlations between the two forms of spending. These groups are more likely to move resources from one strategy to the other rather than expanding both at the same time. This result suggests that the stability of the political environment shapes long-term behavior. Republican aligned defense corporations operate in predictable conditions and therefore benefit from steady investments. Democratic aligned advocacy groups operate in more volatile environments and adjust spending to match shifting opportunities.

Visual evidence from scatterplots strengthens these findings. When organizations are plotted by partisan alignment and complementarity score, defense corporations cluster in the upper right area of the graph. This cluster indicates both high levels of Republican giving and strong complementary spending patterns. Advocacy organizations cluster in the lower or middle regions of the graph, where substitution and mixed strategies are more common. The clear separation between these groups supports the argument

that organizational identity and issue environment shape political behavior. The results provide strong support for the central claim of this study. Defense corporations use complementary strategies because they operate in stable policy subsystems that reward long-term investments in access and electoral support. Advocacy organizations use substitution strategies because they work in fluctuating political environments where opportunities for influence change quickly. Partisan alignment reinforces these patterns, with Republican leaning organizations displaying more consistent behavior and Democratic leaning organizations displaying more flexible behavior.

Figure 3 compares organizational-level spending strategies. Lockheed Martin demonstrates a clear complementary pattern: lobbying and campaign contributions rise and fall together, supporting a long-term access-driven strategy consistent with stable policy subsystems. J Street shows a mixed, election-driven strategy characterized by modest, stable lobbying paired with sharp spikes in campaign contributions during high-stakes election cycles. These examples illustrate how organizational identity and political environment shape spending behavior, reinforcing the broader patterns found across the full dataset.

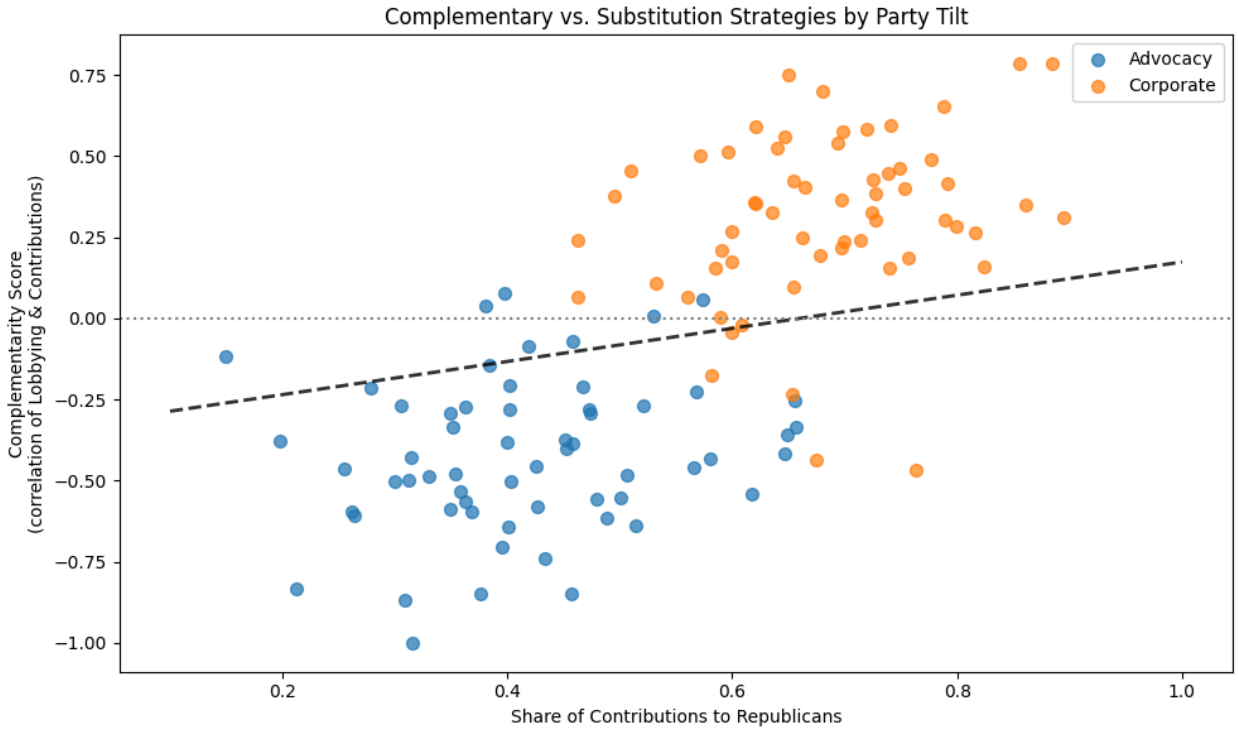

**Fig 3. Organizational-level patterns of complementarity and substitution. Lockheed Martin demonstrates complementary behavior, while J Street shows an election-driven substitution strategy.**

Across all three figures, the visual patterns reinforce the core findings of the study. Defense corporations, operating in stable policy environments with strong Republican alignment, consistently engage in complementary spending. Advocacy organizations, facing volatile political conditions and shifting electoral incentives, rely more heavily on substitution strategies. These visual results align with the expectations of the Advocacy Coalition Framework and strengthen the argument that organizational context, partisan networks, and subsystem stability shape long-term political spending behavior.

These results not only confirm the expectations developed from the Advocacy Coalition Framework but also contribute to broader debates about interest group influence and political spending. By comparing two distinct types of organizations across more than two decades, this analysis shows how money functions differently depending on the political and institutional context. The findings also suggest that spending strategies are shaped by more than simple resource levels. They are shaped by the political environment, the stability of relationships with policymakers, and the strategic needs of each organization.

**Discussion**

The findings from this study help explain how organizations navigate the political environment and why their strategies differ so sharply. The main objective of this discussion is to interpret the results, connect them to the theoretical framework, and show how they support or complicate existing research. Advocacy groups and defense companies differ in that they reflect more profound differences in organizational resources, long-term access to legislators, and policy stability. The analysis shows that political spending is shaped by the structure of the organization and the nature of the policy area in which it operates.

Defense companies act as the Advocacy Coalition Framework suggests they would. They work in a very steady system. The process for military spending and contracts changes very little. The same

congressional groups oversee it year after year. This steadiness means these companies benefit from using both lobbying and campaign gifts at the same time. Lobbying keeps communication open with lawmakers. Campaign donations help keep ties strong with important members of Congress. When both types of spending go up together, it deepens their relationships and protects their future goals.

Advocacy groups face a different situation. Their work on issues like the environment or civil rights depends heavily on the news, what the public thinks, and who wins elections. They do not have the same steady access to power that defense companies do. Their success can change depending on which party is in charge or if their issue is in the spotlight. Because of this, they switch their strategies. When an important election happens, they spend more on campaigns to try to affect the outcome. When Congress starts debating a new law, it focuses its money and effort on lobbying. This back-and-forth spending shows how they must adapt quickly to a political world that is always changing.

Partisanship strengthens these differences. Defense corporations support Republican candidates in high and consistent amounts. This pattern reflects the priorities of the party, the positions of lawmakers on defense spending, and the long history of cooperation between defense firms and key Republican committee members. The relationship between partisan support and complementary strategies is strong in the results. Organizations that give heavily to Republicans tend to increase both lobbying and campaign giving in ways that reinforce long-term access. Partisan alignment, therefore, acts as a stabilizing force for defense corporations.

Advocacy groups display more flexible and dynamic partisan relationships. Although most lean Democratic, their support varies more than that of defense corporations. This variation reflects the diversity of advocacy agendas and the shifting coalitions within the Democratic Party. The results show that Democratic leaning organizations use spending in more flexible ways that change with political conditions. Their strategies match the expectations of groups operating in volatile subsystems. The substitution patterns observed in the data reflect the need to target moments when influence is possible and conserve resources when conditions are less favorable.

The findings also relate to broader debates about money in politics. Scholars often argue that lobbying and campaign giving work together to maintain influence, but this study shows that the relationship depends on the organization. For defense corporations, the two forms of spending reinforce each other. For advocacy groups, the two forms of spending function as strategic alternatives. These results suggest that political spending is not uniform across interest groups. Instead, it reflects the structure of the organization, the stability of the policy area, and the nature of partisan relationships. This insight helps explain why earlier research finds mixed results when trying to identify broad patterns in political spending. Groups face different incentives and behave accordingly.

The overall interpretation of the findings is that political influence is shaped by long-term organizational strategy rather than isolated financial choices. Defense corporations succeed through predictability and stable investment, while advocacy groups succeed through flexibility and timing. This difference helps explain why defense corporations often maintain stronger access to policymakers and why advocacy groups depend more heavily on election outcomes. The variation in strategies also highlights the importance of studying political spending across long time periods. Single-year or short-term studies may miss the broader patterns that become clear when looking at two decades of data.

The results reinforce the value of the Advocacy Coalition Framework as a tool for understanding interest group behavior. The theory predicts that actors in stable subsystems rely on consistent strategies and that actors in volatile subsystems rely on more flexible strategies. The data in this study match those predictions. The spending patterns observed in defense corporations and advocacy organizations demonstrate how policy structure shapes political investment. This research contributes to the broader understanding of how organizations build influence and how money functions differently depending on the conditions in which groups operate.

**Conclusion**

This study set out to understand how defense corporations and advocacy organizations allocate political spending between lobbying and campaign contributions from 2000 to 2024. The central question asked whether these two forms of spending operate as complementary strategies or as substitutes for one

another. The results show that the two types of organizations behave in distinct and predictable ways that reflect their policy environments, long-term goals, and partisan alignments. These differences help clarify why political spending across groups does not follow a single pattern but instead reflects the conditions under which organizations operate.

The analysis demonstrates that defense corporations rely heavily on complementary strategies. They increase lobbying and campaign contributions together in ways that reinforce long-term access to lawmakers. Their policy environment is stable, and their relationships with key committees remain relatively consistent from one Congress to the next. This stability encourages strategies that reward predictability and continuous investment. Complementary spending allows these firms to protect their interests through both legislative access and electoral support, which strengthens their influence over time. Their strong alignment with Republican lawmakers also supports this pattern, since partisan stability reduces the uncertainty surrounding their political relationships.

Advocacy organizations show a different pattern. Their spending reflects the uncertainty and rapid changes that define many of the policy areas they work in. These groups increase campaign contributions in major election years when political turnover is likely and then shift resources toward lobbying when policy windows open. Their strategies match the expectations of the Advocacy Coalition Framework, which predicts that actors in less stable subsystems respond to political events by adjusting their behavior. The substitution and mixed patterns observed in the data show how advocacy groups must balance limited resources with changing opportunities for influence. Their Democratic leaning partisan alignment also contributes to this flexibility, since issue-based coalitions shift more frequently within the Democratic Party.

These findings contribute to the broader understanding of interest group politics by showing that organizations use political spending in ways that match their institutional needs and strategic environments. Political money is not simply a matter of spending more or less. It reflects a deeper logic about how groups maintain influence, form coalitions, and respond to political risk. Defense corporations

succeed through consistency, while advocacy groups rely on strategic timing. This insight helps explain why interest groups often behave differently even when they appear to pursue similar objectives.

The study also shows the value of examining political spending across long periods of time. Short-term analyses may miss the long-term structures that shape interest group behavior. By looking across twenty-four years, this research captures the patterns that emerge only when organizations face repeated electoral cycles, shifts in congressional control, and changes in issue salience. The consistency of the findings strengthens the argument that organizational identity and policy stability are major drivers of political strategy.

In conclusion, the results show that political spending strategies are shaped by a combination of organizational structure, policy environment, and partisan alignment. Defense corporations use complementary strategies that reinforce long-term access in stable policy subsystems. Advocacy organizations use substitution or mixed strategies that respond to political uncertainty and issue-based fluctuations. These distinct strategies reveal how interest groups build and maintain influence in the American political system. The study contributes to ongoing debates about money in politics by demonstrating that spending decisions are neither random nor uniform. They reflect strategic choices that emerge from the political environments in which groups operate.

Future research could build on this study by examining how these spending strategies influence actual policy outcomes, how newer types of organizations, such as hybrid political nonprofits, fit into this framework, and how digital mobilization strategies interact with traditional lobbying and campaign finance. Understanding these dynamics will provide a clearer picture of how political spending shapes the policymaking process in the United States.

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